CO421 Assessment Rubrics – E/21

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What you submit and present

Assessment	Share of CO421	Marked by	What it is
Literature review paper	40%	Two examiners	A written review paper, with a GenAI report
Project proposal presentation	30%	Two examiners	A 12-minute talk followed by 8 minutes of questions
Supervisor evaluation	30%	Your supervisor	Your work and conduct across the semester

Gates for the literature review paper

The paper must meet all three gates before it is marked. A paper that misses a gate is returned to the group until it meets them.

Gate	Requirement
G1 Length	About 2,000 words, excluding references
G2 References	At least 30 cited works that you review, each cited in the text. Other review papers may be added on top
G3 GenAI report	Submitted with the paper

IEEE conference format is recommended.

GenAI

GenAI may be used at AIAS Level 3: to help with ideas, drafting, feedback and refinement, provided you critically evaluate and change what it gives you. GenAI use carries no marks. Your GenAI report should say which tools you used and for what, how you checked the output against sources, and what you changed or rejected. Include a checklist of where you used GenAI (for example, finding papers, summarising papers, drafting, editing, checking references). If you used no GenAI, say so. Fabricated references are an integrity matter.

How scores work

Each criterion is scored 1–10: Excellent 9–10, Good 6–7, Satisfactory 3–4, Unsatisfactory 1–2. A score of 8 sits between Excellent and Good, and 5 between Good and Satisfactory. Each rubric's weighted total is out of 100. The paper and the proposal are each marked by two examiners, and your mark is the mean of the two.

Rubric A: Literature review paper (40% of CO421)

Critical evaluation, comparison and the research gap (A3–A5) together carry 55% of this mark. A paper that summarises one work after another will not score well.

Criterion	Weight	Excellent (9–10)	Good (6–7)	Satisfactory (3–4)	Unsatisfactory (1–2)
A1 Abstract and introduction	10%	Abstract states scope, how the review was done and the main conclusion. Introduction sets the domain, a precise problem statement and the review's scope	All parts present; problem or scope slightly broad	Problem statement vague, or abstract only describes the paper's structure	No clear problem; abstract missing or misleading
A2 Coverage and selection	15%	Covers the main approaches and recent work from credible peer-reviewed venues; organised by theme or approach; no key work missing	Good coverage; minor gaps or a few weak sources	Narrow or dated, or relies on preprints and blogs; organised paper by paper	Key works missing; sources mostly unreliable
A3 Critical evaluation	25%	For each key work, explains strengths, limitations, assumptions and how it was evaluated (data, metrics), in your own judgement	Critique for most key works, sometimes generic	Mostly summary, with occasional critique	Summary only, or claims repeated from abstracts
A4 Comparative analysis and synthesis	15%	Compares works on explicit dimensions (e.g. a comparison table); identifies agreements, contradictions and trends	Comparisons made, but dimensions not explicit	Few comparisons; works treated in isolation	No comparison
A5 Research gap and conclusion	15%	Gap follows from A3–A4, is specific and backed by citations, and leads to clear	Gap clear and supported; link to research	Gap asserted rather than shown (e.g. "no work in Sri	No gap or conclusion

Criterion	Weight	Excellent (9–10)	Good (6–7)	Satisfactory (3–4)	Unsatisfactory (1–2)
		research questions or objectives	questions weaker	Lanka"), or too broad	
A6 Organisation and writing	10%	Logical flow with signposting; clear, concise academic English; almost no errors	Mostly clear; some unclear passages or minor errors	Hard to follow in places; frequent errors	Disorganised; errors obscure the meaning
A7 Citation and referencing	10%	Every claim supported; primary sources; one consistent style; complete entries	Minor inconsistencies	Unsupported claims or second-hand citing; mixed styles	Missing citations, padding (cited but never discussed) or wrong references

Rubric B: Project proposal presentation (30% of CO421)

A 12-minute talk followed by 8 minutes of questions. Every member presents, and examiners will direct questions to members who have not yet answered.

Criterion	Weight	Excellent (9–10)	Good (6–7)	Satisfactory (3–4)	Unsatisfactory (1–2)
B1 Problem and research question	10%	A non-specialist understands the problem, why it matters, and the precise research question or hypothesis early in the talk	Clear problem; question somewhat broad	Problem described; question unclear or missing	No clear problem
B2 Positioning in the literature	30%	Compares the most relevant works on explicit dimensions and shows where the project fits and what it adds	Relevant works compared; contribution less sharp	Lists works without comparing them	Little or no literature
B3 Methodology	20%	Approach, experimental design, data or setup,	Sound approach; some details	Approach in general terms only;	No workable method

Criterion	Weight	Excellent (9–10)	Good (6–7)	Satisfactory (3–4)	Unsatisfactory (1–2)
		baselines and evaluation metrics are defined and suit the question; hypotheses are testable	(baselines, metrics) missing	evaluation unclear	
B4 Work plan and feasibility	10%	Realistic plan through Semester 8 with milestones, owners, resources (compute, data, hardware, ethics approval) and risks with fallbacks	Realistic plan; risks or resources thinly covered	Plan vague, or Semester 8 missing	No plan
B5 Outcomes and deliverables	5%	Concrete deliverables (paper, system, dataset, results) with measurable success criteria	Clear deliverables; success criteria loose	Deliverables vague	None stated
B6 Progress and initial results	10%	Shows real early work (pilot experiment, prototype, collected data) and what it suggests	Some progress; results very preliminary	Setup only, no results	No progress shown
B7 Presentation quality	5%	Clear story; readable slides and figures; within 12 minutes; confident delivery; every member presents	Minor issues with slides, timing or delivery	Hard to follow, text-heavy or well over time	Disorganised
B8 Response to questions	10%	Answers directly and accurately, admits limits, shows understanding beyond the slides; any member can answer	Mostly sound answers; some vague	Often vague, or one member answers everything	Cannot answer basic questions

If your work so far is mainly the literature. For B3, a systematic review method (for example, PRISMA) can count as methodology, alongside your plan for Semester 8. For B6, initial results can come from your review (for example, a structured comparison or a clearly evidenced gap) as well as from early experiments.

Research problem. You do not need a fixed research problem in the literature review paper; the paper builds up to it through the gap (A5). State your research problem and question in the proposal presentation, where it is marked under B1.

Rubric C: Supervisor evaluation (30% of CO421)

Your supervisor marks five criteria, each worth 20%. Scores rest on the records you keep: meeting notes, weekly plans and your repository.

Criterion	Weight	Excellent (9–10)	Good (6–7)	Satisfactory (3–4)	Unsatisfactory (1–2)
C1 Initiative and self-learning	20%	Sets the meeting agenda, proposes next steps, learns new methods or tools unprompted, and acts on feedback by the next meeting	Generally proactive; sometimes waits for direction	Mostly waits for instructions; acts on feedback slowly	Needs repeated prompting
C2 Technical contribution	20%	The literature, ideas and method are the group's own; the supervisor guides rather than supplies	Mostly own work; relies on the supervisor for some key decisions	Supervisor supplies much of the direction	Little contribution of its own
C3 Planning and reporting	20%	Brings a written update and plan to every meeting; notes or diary kept up to date	Regular reporting with occasional gaps	Irregular reporting; notes incomplete	Rarely reports; no records
C4 Progress against plan	20%	Milestones met, or slips explained and recovered; work is productive and of good quality	Most milestones met	Repeated slips; progress below what the plan needed	Little progress
C5 Teamwork	20%	Work shared fairly; every member can explain the whole project; problems	Mostly balanced; minor	Noticeable imbalance or coordination	One member carries the group, or the group is not

Criterion	Weight	Excellent (9–10)	Good (6–7)	Satisfactory (3–4)	Unsatisfactory (1–2)
		resolved within the group	imbalance	problems	functioning

This is a group mark. Where contribution is clearly unequal, your supervisor may adjust an individual's mark, with the evidence recorded.